CHENG, Ming 程明

Postdoctoral Fellow, Music and Culture Technology Lab, Institute of Information Science, Academia Sinica
Ph.D. in Musicology, National Taiwan University (2026)
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Last updated: July 2026

Education

2015–2026	Ph.D., Graduate Institute of Musicology, National Taiwan University (candidacy 2021; degree conferred July 2026)
2012–2015	Master's program, Graduate Institute of Musicology, National Taiwan University (transferred to Ph.D. program)
2004–2010	M.A. in Philosophy, Department of German Culture, Soochow University (major in German philosophy; minor in German literature)
1999–2004	B.A. (double major), Department of German Language and Literature / Division of Creative Writing, Department of Chinese Literature, Chinese Culture University

Ph.D. Dissertation
Ming Cheng, "The Closure and Loosening of the Recording Studio: Behind-the-Scenes as Method for Narrating Postwar Taiwanese Popular Music History" (錄音室的封閉與鬆動：以幕後為方法的戰後臺灣流行音樂歷史敘事), Ph.D. dissertation, Graduate Institute of Musicology, National Taiwan University, 2026. Advisor: Prof. Fumitaka Yamauchi.

Master's Thesis
Ming Cheng, "A Study on Ernst Cassirer's Concept of 'Animal Symbolicum'," M.A. thesis, Department of German Culture, Soochow University, 2010. Advisor: Prof. Dong-Liang You.

Professional Experience

2026–2027	Visiting Researcher (forthcoming), Sony Computer Science Laboratories, Tokyo (host: Dr. Vincent Cheung), and Graduate School of Global Arts, Tokyo University of the Arts (host: Prof. Yoshitaka Mouri), 7 December 2026 – 26 February 2027; Fellowship for Research in Japan, Japan-Taiwan Exchange Association
2026–present	Postdoctoral Fellow, Music and Culture Technology Lab (MCT Lab, PI Dr. Li Su), Institute of Information Science, Academia Sinica (since August 2026)
2022–2026	Research Assistant (full-time; Aug 2022–Jan 2024 and Aug 2025–Jul 2026) and Ph.D. Student (Scholarship Recipient; Feb 2024–Jul 2025), Music and Culture Technology Lab, Institute of Information Science, Academia Sinica
1995–present	Freelance session musician (guitar); album recordings, film scoring, and live performances

Research Experience

2025–2026	Academia Sinica project "Innovative Applications of AI in Humanities and Sciences" (No. AS-IAIA-114-M06), directed by Dr. Li Su and co-directed by Assoc. Prof. Chien-Chang Yang. Postdoctoral Fellow (since August 2026; Research Assistant 2025–2026). Researching postwar Taiwanese popular music history with social network analysis and deep learning; building a musician collaboration network database of 2,536 analysable albums, filtered from 4,664 scanned LP sleeve records dated 1957–2016.
2022	Part-time Research Assistant, MOST project "Coloniality of Sound: The Historicity of Singing in Colonial Taiwan," directed by Assoc. Prof. Chien-Chang Yang, Graduate Institute of Musicology, National Taiwan University.
2018–2022	Part-time Research Assistant, MOST project "Phonographic Modernity and East Asian Music History," directed by Prof. Fumitaka Yamauchi, Graduate Institute of Musicology, National Taiwan University. Assisted with research, literature, and data collection.

2015–2016 Part-time Research Assistant, chapter on musicology and ethnomusicology for the MOST Research Center for Humanities and Social Sciences project "Trending and Prospective Research Topics in the Arts," supervised by Assoc. Research Fellow Dr. Hsin-Chun Tasaw Lu, Institute of Ethnology, Academia Sinica.

2004–2005 Part-time Research Assistant, Government Information Office commissioned project "Comparative Analysis of Digitalization Strategies of Cable TV in Major Countries and Feasibility Analysis of Comprehensive Digitalization of Cable TV in Taiwan," directed by Prof. Yu-Li Liu, Department of Radio and Television, National Chengchi University. Responsible for collecting, translating, and analyzing German-language materials.

Fieldwork

- Ongoing interview-based fieldwork with Yeh Chui-Ching, founder of Platinum Studio (2018–2022). Concurrent participation in Audio Engineering Society (AES) Taiwan Section activities, building professional networks in Taiwan's recording industry.

Publications

Journal Articles

1. 程明，〈聲響技術的跨域交纏：臺灣國語流行音樂錄音室研究初探〉，《民俗曲藝》第 213 期，頁 49–95，2021 年。

Conference Papers

1. Ming Cheng, Yung-Chuan Chang, Chien-Chang Yang, and Li Su, "Digital Existence as Ontological Intervention: Backstage Networks in Postwar Taiwanese Popular Music," Proceedings of the 27th International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference (ISMIR), Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates, 8–12 November 2026. *(accepted, forthcoming; Best Paper Nominee)*
2. Ming Cheng, Yun-En Tsai, and Li Su, "Reconstructing the Historical Ontology of a Popular Music World: A Multi-Agent LLM Pipeline Applied to an Oral History Archive from Postwar Taiwan," The Fourth International Conference on Computational and Cognitive Musicology (ICCCM 2026), Julius-Maximilians-Universität Würzburg, Würzburg, Germany, 21–23 September 2026. *(poster, accepted)*
3. Ming Cheng, "Understanding the Localization of Production Practice: A Cross-Modal Narrative of Post-War Taiwanese Popular Music," The Second International Conference in AI Music Studies: Inside the Music: Prospects, Challenges and Methodologies of Studying AI Music in the Humanities and Social Sciences, University of Nottingham, UK, 30 March–1 April 2026.
4. 程明、蘇黎、楊建章、黃郁芬，〈從檔案到圖譜：以社會網絡為核心的戰後臺灣音樂人跨域分析〉，第十六屆數位典藏與數位人文國際研討會，國立臺灣大學，臺北，2025 年 11 月 30 日。
5. 程明、蘇黎、楊建章，〈戰後臺灣音樂人資料庫建構與語言模型應用初探——兼論社群結構、樂種生成與可視化分析〉，臺灣音樂學會 2025 年度學術研討會，Panel 2A：計算音樂學與 AI，國立臺灣歷史博物館，臺南，2025 年 11 月 22 日。
6. 程明，〈臺灣流行音樂幕後與歷史書寫〉，臺灣音樂學會 2024 年度研討會，國立臺灣大學文學院，臺北，2024 年 12 月 1 日。
7. Ying-Shuo Lee, Yueh-Po Peng, Jui-Te Wu, Ming Cheng, Li Su, and Yi-Hsuan Yang, "Distortion Recovery: A Two-Stage Method for Guitar Effect Removal," Proceedings of the 27th International Conference on Digital Audio Effects (DAFx24), University of Surrey, Guildford, UK, 3–7 September 2024.
8. 程明，〈樂匠抑或是音樂家：1980 年代臺灣錄音室科技與樂手的合作結構與音樂產製的藝術與審美〉，音樂的傳統與未來──2020 臺灣音樂學會暨臺灣音樂學論壇年度研討會，國立臺灣師範大學，臺北，2020 年 11 月 21 日。
9. Ming Cheng, "'First Records' The Great Wall Ballad Recording Session: A Preliminary Attempt onto the Musicology of Studio Production," The Fifth International Project on Art and Aesthetics: Multiculturality and Materiality in Arts and Aesthetics — Theory and Practice, National Taiwan University, Taipei, 14 December 2019.

10. 程明，〈第一唱片《長城謠》錄音事件——一個錄音室音樂學的初探〉，音樂的傳統與未來──2019 臺灣音樂學會暨臺灣音樂學論壇年度研討會，國立臺南藝術大學，臺南，2019 年 11 月 16 日。
11. 程明，〈傳統與技術對立中的唱片聆賞與康德自在遊戲概念初探〉，2015 臺灣音樂學論壇，國立中山大學，高雄，2015 年 11 月 21 日。
12. Ming Cheng, "From Musical Visualization to Remix: Toward an Interpretation of the Musical Practices of Hip-hop DJs," East Asian Graduate Exchange Seminar in Musicology: Listening People, Listening Peoples, The University of Tokyo, Tokyo, Japan, 22–24 November 2014.
13. Ming Cheng, "Musical Visualization Revisited," CUHK-NTU Music Forum 2014: Sound, Image, and Representation, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong, 2–3 May 2014.
14. 程明，〈音樂具象化的反思──以 Re:Generation 計劃為例〉，2013 臺灣音樂學論壇，國立臺灣大學，臺北，2013 年 10 月 19 日。

Theses

1. Ming Cheng, "The Closure and Loosening of the Recording Studio: Behind-the-Scenes as Method for Narrating Postwar Taiwanese Popular Music History" (錄音室的封閉與鬆動：以幕後為方法的戰後臺灣流行音樂歷史敘事), Ph.D. dissertation, Graduate Institute of Musicology, National Taiwan University, 2026. Advisor: Prof. Fumitaka Yamauchi.
2. Ming Cheng, "A Study on Ernst Cassirer's Concept of 'Animal Symbolicum'," M.A. thesis, Department of German Culture, Soochow University, 2010. Advisor: Prof. Dong-Liang You.

Book Reviews

1. Diau-long Shen, Rachel Adelstein, Pei-ling Huang, Min-erh Wang, Hui-ping Lee, and Ming Cheng, review of Studies on a Global History of Music: A Balzan Musicology Project, ed. Reinhard Strohm (London and New York: Routledge, 2018), Ethnomusicology Forum 32, no. 2 (2023): 311–314. DOI: 10.1080/17411912.2022.2127117.

Other Publications

1. 程明（合著），《世界重要國家有線電視數位化策略之比較分析暨我國有線電視全面數位化可行策略研析》，行政院新聞局有線廣播電視事業發展基金委託專題研究報告（未出版），2004 年。

Invited Lectures

- "Audio Technology and Taiwanese Popular Music 1945–1990," guest lecture for Prof. Lap Kwan Kam's course Music, Technology and Society: Since 1877, Graduate Institute of Music, National Yang Ming Chiao Tung University, Hsinchu, May 17, 2022.
- "Audio Technology and Behind-the-Scenes Research on Popular Music in Postwar Taiwan: A Study in Studio Musicology," invited lecture, Audio Engineering Society (AES) Taiwan Section, December 23, 2021.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant

2017–2025	**German I** (Prof. Chia-Ying Tsai, NTU Second Foreign Language Program); grading assignments and exams; substitute teaching
2019–2020	**Cultural and Creative Industries: Theories and Practices** (Prof. Szu-Wei Chen, NTU GMBA); taught in English
2014–2018	**Global Music Cultures** (Prof. Szu-Wei Chen, NTU General Education); Outstanding Teaching Assistant, semester 2016-2
2015-2	**Mahler and Viennese Modernism** (Prof. Lap Kwan Kam, NTU General Education); TA discussion sections
2014-1	**Media, Machine, Music: a Graduate Seminar** (Prof. Fumitaka Yamauchi, NTU Graduate Institute of Musicology); taught in English

Teaching Positions

- Guitar teacher, school clubs (including the Academia Sinica Guitar Club) and private music studios in Taipei (1995–present).
- German teacher, Günters Deutsch-Studio (2017–2024); textbooks Menschen and Netzwerk Neu.

Professional Service

2026	Reviewer, APSIPA Transactions on Signal and Information Processing (APSIPA T-SIP), journal
2026	Reviewer, 27th International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference (ISMIR 2026)
2026	Reviewer, International Conference on Digital Audio Effects (DAFx 2026)
2019	Coordinating Assistant, The Fifth International Project on Art and Aesthetics (directed by Prof. Chien-Chang Yang, National Taiwan University). Responsible for conference preparation, organizing and coordinating the assistant team, liaising with domestic and international scholars, and administrative coordination.

Grants & Fellowships

2026–2027	Fellowship for Research in Japan (Humanities and Social Sciences), Japan-Taiwan Exchange Association. Research topic: "Technology Transfer in Recording and the Formation of Music Culture: Giichi Hirata and the Japan–Taiwan Behind-the-Scenes Network." Host: Sony Computer Science Laboratories (Dr. Vincent Cheung); concurrently visiting researcher at the Graduate School of Global Arts, Tokyo University of the Arts (Prof. Yoshitaka Mouri), 7 December 2026 – 26 February 2027 (82 days in total; 45 days funded by the Association).

Awards & Honors

- Best Paper Nominee, 27th International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference (ISMIR 2026), for "Digital Existence as Ontological Intervention: Backstage Networks in Postwar Taiwanese Popular Music" (first author).
- Outstanding Teaching Assistant, National Taiwan University (semester 2016-2), course: Global Music Cultures (Prof. Szu-Wei Chen).
- Summer course scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD); second award. University of Trier.
- Summer course scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD); Universities of Tübingen and Freiburg.

Languages

Mandarin Chinese (native), German (upper-intermediate), English (upper-intermediate), Japanese (intermediate)

Selected Professional Music Experience

Active in Taiwan's music industry as a freelance session guitarist since 1995, contributing to album recordings, film scoring, and live performances. This experience grounds my recording studio research in first-hand industry knowledge and field observation. Selected works:

- Compilation album Asian Hit in Jazz, Sound States, Tokyo, 2014.
- Yu Chia-Lun, Dan Shen Liang Pin (單身涼品), Asia Muse Entertainment, 2012.
- Afternoon Tree Crossover Jazz Ensemble, Rosemary (迷迭香), Wind Music, 2012.
- Film score recording for Forever Love (阿嬤的夢中情人), 2013.
- Music director and arranger, new Taiwanese opera Yue (越) by Yuan He Ju Zi, Weiwuying National Kaohsiung Center for the Arts, 2014.